NOT MEASUREMENT SENSITIVE

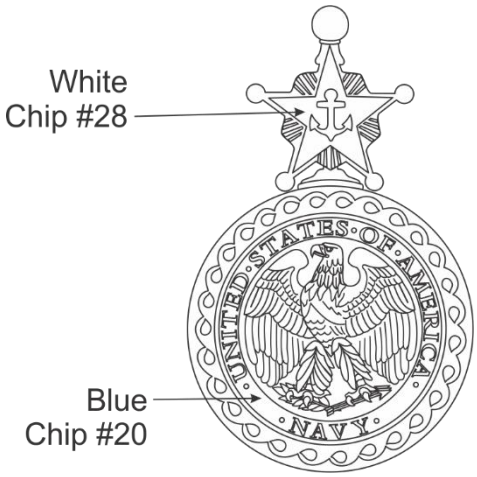
MIL-DTL-3943/8M
29 April 2021
SUPERSEDING
MIL-DTL-3943/8L
27 June 2016

DETAIL SPECIFICATION SHEET

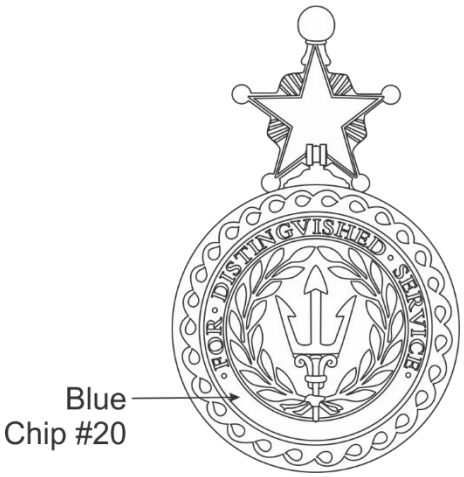
DECORATION, DISTINGUISHED SERVICE MEDAL, U.S. NAVY AND U.S. MARINE CORPS

This specification is approved for use by all
Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense

The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and the latest issue of MIL-DTL-3943.



OBVERSE



REVERSE

DASH NO.
-1: Regular Size
-2: Miniature Size

MATERIAL: Red Brass 85/15 (UNS Alloy No. C-230)

FINISH:
PENDANT: Epoxy resin, 24KGold Plated, Matte Finish and shall match The Institute of Heraldry (TIOH) Metal Finish Chip Number 7.
STAR: Epoxy resin, 24KGold Plated, Matte Finish and shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 7

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:43Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

DIMENSIONS:
PENDANT:
DIAMETER:
-1: 1-1/4 inches (REF)
-2: 5/8 inch (REF)
HEIGHT (Including hinge rotor):
-1: 1-1/2 inches (REF)
-2: 27/32 inch (REF)
THICKNESS (At Thickest point):
-1: 0.190 inch ± 0.010 inch
-2: 0.130 inch ± 0.010 inch
SUSPENSION STAR:
HEIGHT (Including lug):
-1: 29/32 inch (REF)
-2: 7/16 inch (REF)
WIDTH (Overall)
-1: 25/32 inch (REF)
-2: 3/8 inch (REF)
THICKNESS (At center of device):
-1: 0.125 inch ± 0.010 inch
-2: 0.075 inch ± 0.010 inch

EPOXY: Epoxy resin (Stoning epoxy) shall be applied to the Decoration as indicated above, and shall match TIOH Hard Enamel Color Chip Numbers listed below.

TIOH HARD ENAMEL COLOR CHIPS	
COLOR	**CHIP NUMBER**
Dark Blue	#20
White	#28

DECORATION SET: Decoration set shall consist of a regular size medal, a service ribbon, and a lapel button all packaged in a presentation case conforming to MIL-DTL-14633, Type V, Style 5 with a Class 1 or 1A pad.

NOTES:
1. The term (REF) refers to the measurements taken from the Government furnished hub or die.

2. Suspension star shall be secured to the pendant by a hinge joint.

3. The hinge for -1 shall be 1/8 inch ± 1/64 inch high by 1/8 inch ± 1/64 inch wide by 3/16 inch ± 1/64 inch deep. The hinge for -2 shall be 1/16 inch ± 1/64 inch high by 1/16 inch ± 1/64 inch wide by 3/32 inch ± 1/64 inch deep.

4. Hinges for -1 shall be soldered to the vertical center line of the star 5/32 inch ± 1/64 inch up from the lower edge. Hinges for -2 shall be soldered to the vertical center line of the star 5/64 inch ± 1/64 inch up from the lower edge.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:43Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. The specification slash sheet for the ribbon for the pendant drape and for the service ribbon is MIL-DTL-11589/102.

6. The specification slash sheet for the lapel button is MIL-DTL-11484/5.

7. The use of any type of plastic packaging material is prohibited.

8. For commercial sale only may be manufactured using 24K Gold Plate Mirror-like Polished and shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 6.

CHANGES FROM PREVIOUS ISSUE: Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - IH
Navy - NU

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

Review activities:
Navy - MC
DLA - CT

(Project No. 8455-2021-397)

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:43Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.